FREE · PREPARED AT HOME

The Water Card

How much to store, and how to make water safe when the tap isn't. Print it, tape it inside a cabinet door.

HOW MUCH TO STORE

- **1 gallon per person, per day** (drinking and basic hygiene).
- **3 days** minimum. **2 weeks** at home if you can.
- Add water for pets, and extra for nursing mothers, kids, the sick and hot weather.
- Family of 4 for 2 weeks: **56 gallons**.

STORING IT RIGHT

- Buy sealed bottled water, or fill clean **food-grade** containers.
- Never use milk jugs or containers that held chemicals.
- Keep it in a cool, dark place.
- Replace water you bottled yourself **every 6 months**. Store-bought: by its date.

BOIL FIRST IF YOU CAN

Bring clear water to a **rolling boil for 1 minute** (**3 minutes** above 6,500 feet), let it cool, and store it in clean covered containers. Boiling kills germs that bleach can miss, like *Giardia* and *Cryptosporidium*.

NO WAY TO BOIL? USE PLAIN BLEACH

Water	Regular bleach (6%)	Concentrated (8.25%)
1 quart or liter	2 drops	2 drops
1 gallon	8 drops	6 drops
2 gallons	16 drops (¼ tsp)	12 drops (⅛ tsp)
4 gallons	⅓ tsp	¼ tsp
8 gallons	⅔ tsp	½ tsp

Use only plain, unscented household bleach. Not scented, color-safe or splash-less, and nothing with added cleaners. Check the label for the percent. Use a clean eyedropper.

1 **Cloudy?** Let it settle, pour off the clear water, strain it through a clean cloth.

2 **Add the drops.** Cloudy, colored or very cold water: use **double**.

3 **Stir and wait 30 minutes.** It should smell faintly of bleach.

4 **No smell?** Add the same dose again and wait 15 more minutes.

When to stop and get help: if officials say the water is contaminated with fuel or chemicals, bleach and boiling won't fix it. Use bottled water and follow local instructions.

✂ FRIDGE CARD

Boil 1 minute. Or bleach: 8 drops a gallon (6%), 6 drops (8.25%). Wait 30 minutes.

Cloudy water: strain, then double it. 1 gallon per person per day.

Figures from the U.S. EPA "Emergency Disinfection of Drinking Water," CDC "How to Make Water Safe in an Emergency," and Ready.gov water storage guidance. A planning aid, not professional advice; follow your local officials.

Prepared at Home
The full 90-Day Home Readiness Kit:
preparedathome.netlify.app